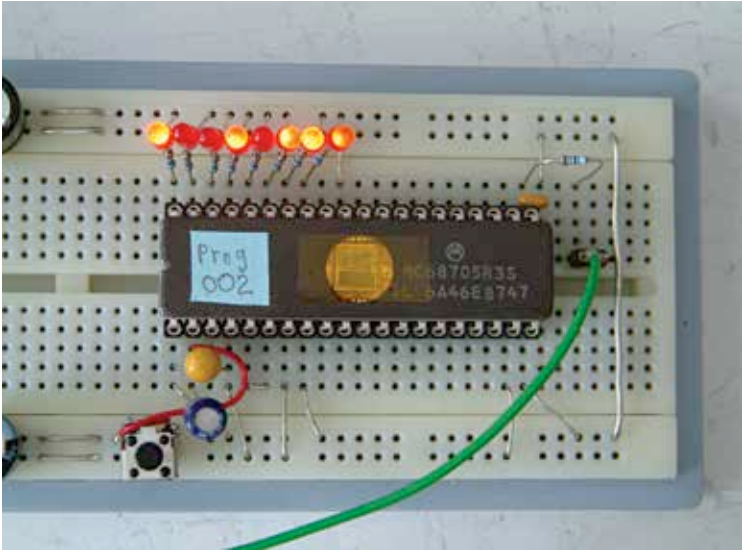




Whether its a hobby project or mission critical code running on an embedded device, chances are it was written in C.

memory locations. As you can imagine, this makes it the perfect candidate for system programming.

Few other languages are as suitable, or as highly used in writing low-level code such as operating system kernels or device drivers. One only needs to look at the three major operating system families to see proof of that. The Linux kernel, the OSX kernel (Mach / Darwin) and the Windows (NT) kernel are all mostly written in C, with some Assembly thrown in. In fact when one encounters a kernel not written in C, it is often a point to highlight.

Another field where C has a significant market share is in programming embedded systems. Low-level systems such as the ones that control various systems in cars, from ABS to managing fuel / air mixtures etc. Since these systems are mission critical, and you wouldn't want a blue screen of literal death, the version of C used in such systems is often a restricted one. After all, you can't really patch you car to car 1.0.1 if they detect a bug later on!

It is also an incredible point in its favour that C is the language in which the interpreters of popular languages such as Python, PHP, Ruby and Lua are written.